The Weekly Times.

THURSDAY, JUNE 10, 1875.

THE NON-PLUSSED ORGANS.

The Hon. Edward Blake's address to his constituents in South Bruce, immediately after his acceptance of office, afforded little consolation to the Opposition organs. They expected, apparently, a political manifesto, but had to be content with a few brief paragraphs instead—paragraphs, however, which contained all that was necessary for the occasion and the people to whom they were addressed. Mr. Blake placed himself unreservedly in the hands of his constituents, and promised a cheerful acquiescence in their verdict, whether it should be favorable or adverse. The disappointed organs rightly concluded that the member for South Bruce would make a speech at the nomination, in which he would explain, at length, the reasons which had induced him to forego his own inclinations and enter the Cabinet of Mr. Mackenzie, and more fully detail his opinions on the public issues of the day. The confidence reposed in the electors of South Bruce has met with its proper return, the nomination speech has been delivered—characterized, like all Mr. Blake's public efforts, by fairness, by thoughtfulness and by the spirit of true independence, but still giving unmixed satisfaction neither to the Opposition press nor to the *Globe*. It is proverbially hard to please everybody, and no man who is at the same time honest and wise ever makes the essay. To please the *Mail* and its satellites would be impossible; to please the *Globe* would be almost equally futile, unless a man of independent thought should consent to forego that independence. The Hon. Edward Blake, about whose utterances these journals are so much concerned, does not himself seem much concerned about their opinions. For a comparatively young politician he knows his fellow-countrymen remarkably well. He understands thoroughly their wishes, their wants, and their aspirations. He has faith in their integrity as a whole, and they have faith in his ability and singleness of purpose. There is probably not a constituency in the country that would not be proud to have him for its representative to-day, so general is the admiration of his character and talents. Thus it is that Mr. Blake comes to be, not the representative of South Bruce only, but the representative of a much more extended constituency, having a larger personal following than any other Canadian now in public life. The words of such a man, therefore, must have great weight, and these, as well as his example, must necessarily exercise great influence. Mr. Blake's speech at Walkerton the other day, however much it may have fallen short of the expectations of his enemies, has not disappointed his friends. It shows clearly and unequivocally that, in accepting a portfolio and a seat at this Council Board, he has sacrificed none of his cherished principles, that, in all questions of public policy whether *in esse* or *en futuro*, the Premier and himself are in perfect accord, and that now, for the first time, he has resolved to enter, in earnest, upon the discharge of the duties of a Cabinet Minister. But it shows more than this. It shows that the new Minister of Justice will neither submit to dictation himself nor remain a member of a Government that submits to it, and, therefore, while greatly adding to the strength and stability of Mr. Mackenzie's Cabinet, by drawing to it the support of all independent minds, at the same time deprives the Opposition press and the Opposition itself of one of their most potent weapons of attack. The principles that Mr. Blake lays down in his speech are the principles of Reformers the world over. The electorate—the people—are recognized as the true, the only source of all political power. The Government is their creature, their servant—not their master; parliament, the instrument they employ to hold the Government in check. The recognition of this doctrine is what distinguishes a true Reformer from a true Tory, and underlies the whole theory of Responsible Government. From this consideration it is manifest, however, that all are not Reformers who are so-called, nor all Tories who are so-called, and that arbitrary and illiberal men are to be found on both sides of politics. But with this class, wherever its members are found, Mr. Blake has no sympathy, and from them probably he expects little hearty support. The "rest and be thankful" policy is not his policy. He cannot sympathize with "a Reform party that said there was nothing to reform; a Liberal party that said there was nothing to liberalize; or with a progressive party that advocated the policy of standing still." The "disturbing" questions first broached in his Aurora speech, and which so shocked the Conservative principles of the *Globe*, Mr. Blake still considers legitimate subjects for intelligent public discussion, and, indeed, one of the most notable portions of his address is that in which he pleads for freedom of speech. The *Globe*, while commenting on and criticising the address, claims that it has as good a right to pronounce the discussion of such topics as "the re-organization of the Senate," "compulsory voting," the "representation of minorities," the "federation of the Empire," &c., absurd and dangerous, as Mr. Blake had to promulgate them in the first instance. No one, we suppose, disputes that claim. This is a free country, and men may say and write what they will within the bounds limited by law. But it is noteworthy and a little instructive, that the *Globe*, the *Mail*, and the whole Conservative press denounced, in true Tory fashion, the doctrines enunciated by Mr. Blake at Aurora and still held by him. Now, it is one thing to denounce as dangerous and absurd, and it is another thing to prove. The former anybody can do, but the latter calls for knowledge and intellectual effort. Scarcely a reform of any moment has ever been effected without unthinking and often violent opposition at the outset, and Reformers have usually been men in advance of their age. Their ordinary course is as follows: the student in his closet thinks them out, as Jeremy Bentham did his law reforms; others read them; the press seizes upon them so soon as they excite attention; they are submitted to the ordeal of discussion there and among the people; they finally attain sufficient importance to be considered in the legislature and to become "crystalized," to use Mr. Blake's expression, "into Acts of Parliament." This is all that is asked for the "disturbing" Reformers of the famous Aurora speech—a fair field and no favor. If it can be demonstrated that revolution and not "reform" would be the result of their adoption, let it be done by fair argument. *Festina lente* is an excellent motto in most cases of constitutional change, but the *Globe* forgot it at the time of Confederation, a question which it declined to submit to the judgment of the people. Mr. Blake differs from the *Globe* in this that he is willing, nay, that he insists, that the people shall be allowed to consider beforehand radical constitutional changes; that all the arguments for and against them shall be laid before them temporarily and fairly, and that they have a direct voice in their adoption or rejection. It is for the people to choose which they will follow, the intolerant dictates of journals, which, in matters vitally affecting the constitution of the country, ignore their existence altogether, or the statesman who has the mind to think for himself, the courage to express his thoughts, whether popular or unpopular, and the liberality to submit them for the consideration and intelligent judgment of his fellow-countrymen.

VILIFYING PUBLIC MEN.

It is one of the phases of party warfare in this country, be it evil or not, to attack on every possible occasion, and with the Tories on very many impossible ones, if the non-existence of facts are supposed to constitute them, the public character of our leading politicians. The practice is not at all singular to Canada, for it is to be met with across the borders, where, perhaps, it is indulged in more than in any other land in the world. At home, among ourselves, we overlook this habit for more than one reason. One of the first is that if a public man is unjustly assailed he can reply; his friends can meet the attack. Both parties being strong and well in hand, accusations can be met and if untrue controverted. Here, then, a politician can at least depend upon a friendly word being said or written on his behalf.

But what are we to say of those hirelings of foreign journals, who in order to earn a paltry salary, which they well know depends in proportion upon the raciness of their correspondence, pen columns of wretched falsehood and send it abroad to poison the minds of others against Canada? What should we say of men who concoct villainous statements, distort facts, weave whole tissues of nonsense and mendacity, and publish them to the world as an impartial description of this country and her public men? These correspondents whose highest incentive is a dollar or two, for which, facts or fiction will flow with equal ease from their facile pens, constitute one of the curses of this Dominion. Were they themselves foreigners, looking at us and ours through partial and biassed mediums, some excuse might be found for them on the score of ignorance, envy or malice, but it is not always the case that these correspondents are sent here; they are generally picked out and employed from among Canadian writers. We say it with sorrow, but there are those in this country who either forget their duty to it, or quench every spark of manliness and patriotism in their bosoms. These men write regularly for leading American newspapers and in order to attract attention to their productions say anything or everything, their sole measure being the foreign appetite for the sensational and exaggerated. Of late, some most vile and slanderous statements have been furnished the newspapers across the lines, and the dominant party in Canada be-spattered with calumny and falsehood. Leading politicians have been mercilessly attacked, where they could obtain no redress, by the publication of statements which would not be permitted to get into print in Canada. Their private lives and their business have been picked to pieces in order to fish up some incident or accident, which would make a "telling fact" upon a foreign and prejudiced reader. It is not difficult to trace the paternity of these writings to men in the Conservative ranks, men who write for the Conservative press. Occasionally some of the Conservative journals copy their odious fabrications and endeavor to impress their readers with the idea that the opinions expressed in the correspondence are *bona fide* American ones, penned by men who are employed to come to Canada and write impartially of the country. We see such editorial remarks as these, which are actual illustrations: "The special "Canada correspondent of the —— does not "share in the fulsome adulation which the "public have for some time bestowed on the "gentleman whose patronymic heads this "paragraph;" "it is therefore pleasant to "the reader to have an opportunity to read "the views of a dispassionate observer." These "dispassionate observers" are prejudiced and partial, if Bohemians such as they are ever the victims of any such noble motives, and find shelter in the Conservative ranks. They are not unfrequently of the class of men, such as the correspondent of a New York paper, who, in 1867, drew no inconsiderable attention to his letters on the Fenians in Canada, but who was detected as an operator in an eastern telegraph office, using the private and Governmental dispatches passing within his hearing, over the wires, as the texts for the sensational trash he wrote. He had to flee the country but a few days before the troubles began in this region. Intelligence, of the most confidential nature, by his pen reached the paper for which he was correspondent, and some embarrassment was the consequence at times. It is to such as he that many Americans are indebted for their knowledge of Canada and Canadians.

WHY?

Mr. Barber, of Halton, was disqualified because he was sworn to have promised "a "nice present" to an old woman. This he stoutly denied, and there seems to be but little doubt of his being able to set aside, in the Court of Appeal, not only his disqualification, but his loss of the seat. Mr. Stock was unseated and disqualified, because on the day of polling he drank a glass of beer with a supporter. But we have an extraordinary exception, if the above two cases are to be accepted as examples of the rule the Judges have laid down. Mr. Baker, of Russell, has been unseated, when not only that but his disqualification were expected. It was proven, and not denied, that he had treated the electors, paid $5 to a hotel keeper for his dinner, and when called back to receive his change, having thrown down the money, that he said he would get it next day. He was at the hotel on the following day, but did not ask for the change, though he again treated, and left $5 to be used in hiring an agent. When his election was protested, he went and got the $5 back, having told the hotel keeper that he was to be tried for corrupt practices. When Baker was looking out for agents, he was introduced to a man named McArdle. The latter told him that it was no use to offer him money, as it would not influence his vote. Baker said he would see that McArdle would "not lose his time," for, being a "man of "wealth, $40 or $50 was nothing to him." He further told his prospective agent that if he was elected, he would have power to confer favors. He showed his thorough knowledge of the law by adding that "he could not speak as "*freely* as he wished." This is but a sample of the evidence. And the climax was added when Baker pleaded guilty and left the Judge to sentence him. Therefore, we ask, why was it that a man who far exceeded either Mr. Barber or Mr. Stock, was not disqualified as well as unseated? To the common mind, it appears very much that fish is being made of some and flesh of others. That Baker should have been placed under political disability, or that Messrs. Barber and Stock should not have been, will be views which may fairly be entertained.

MONCK.

The Conservatives are at last in the field in Monck. They have nominated the late member, Mr. McCallum, to oppose Mr. J. D. Edgar for the Commons and Mr. George Secord to contest the Riding for the Legislative Assembly, against the old member, Dr. Haney. In both instances the Reformers are hopeful. The only advantage Mr. McCallum possesses over Mr. Edgar is that solely of being a resident. This the latter overrides by his far superior qualification for the position of member in which Mr. McCallum was never happy. His majority over Mr. Edgar in 1874 was but 34, which can be easily converted into a victory for the gentleman then defeated, more by circumstances over which he had no control than by the peculiar fitness for the trust enjoyed by Mr. McCallum. It is chiefly by Dr. Haney's election last January that the temper of the Riding is to be judged. On that occasion he defeated, by 312 votes, no less a person than Mr. Hill, who had on several occasions been a candidate, and was well known in the county. The issues have not changed since then, and the Doctor is confident of his election. If he be so, why not Mr. Edgar also, both being identified with the same cause, and both going to their constituents on practically the same grounds? Mr. Secord, who has been brought out as Dr. Haney's opponent, is unknown, and, from what we can gather, is put forward for the sole purpose of preventing the late member being elected by acclamation.

Reports recently received from those portions of southeastern Nebraska, which have been severely afflicted by grasshoppers this spring, show that the grasshoppers are fast taking flight and going northwest.

This year the Southern counties of California sent to San Francisco 5,380,000 oranges, 620,000 lemons, and 80,000 limes. The consumption of California is about 10,000,000 oranges a year, and 5,000,000 are brought from Mexico and the Pacific Isles.

Rules for the Care of the Eyes.

By Dr. D. F. Lincoln, Secretary of the Department of Health, A.S.S.A.

When writing, reading, drawing, sewing, etc., always take care that

(a.) The room is comfortably cool, and the feet warm;

(b.) There is nothing tight about the neck;

(c.) There is plenty of light without dazzling the eyes;

(d.) The sun does not shine directly on the object we are at work upon;

(e.) The light does not come from in front! it is best when it comes over the left shoulder;

(f.) The head is not very much bent over the work;

(g.) The page is nearly perpendicular to the line of sight: that is, that the eye is nearly opposite the middle of the page, for an object held slanting is not seen so clearly;

(h.) That the page, or other object, is not less than 15 inches from the eye.

In any case, avoid fine needle-work, drawing of fine maps, and all such work, except for very short tasks, not exceeding half an hour each, and in the morning, when the eyes have any defect.

Never study or write before breakfast by candlelight.

Do not lie down when reading.

If your eyes are aching from fire light, from looking at the snow, from over-work or other causes, a pair of colored glasses may be advised, to be used for a while. Light blue or grayish blue is the best shade, but these glasses are likely to be abused, and usually are not to be worn except under medical advice. Almost all those persons who continue to wear colored glasses, having perhaps received advice to wear them from medical men, would be better without them. Travelling venders of spectacles are not to be trusted; their wares are apt to be recommended as ignorantly and indiscriminately as in the times of the "Vicar of Wakefield."

If you have to hold the pages of *Harper's Magazine* nearer than 15 inches in order to read it easily, it is probable that you are quite near-sighted. If you have to hold it two or three feet away before you see easily, you are probably far-sighted. In either case, it is very desirable to consult a physician before getting a pair of glasses, for a misfit may injure your eyes.

Never play tricks with the eyes, as squinting or rolling them.

The eyes are often troublesome when the stomach is out of order.

Avoid reading or sewing by twilight, or when debilitated by recent illness, especially fever, or, in the case of women, by child-birth.

Every seamstress ought to have a cutting-out-table to place her work on such a plane with reference to the line of vision as to make it possible to exercise a close scrutiny without bending the head or the figure much forward.

Usually, except for aged persons or chronic invalids, the winter temperature in work-rooms ought not to exceed 60° or 65°. To sit with impunity in a room at a lower temperature some added clothing will be necessary. The feet of a student or seamstress should be kept comfortably warm while tasks are being done. Slippers are bad. In winter the temperature of the lower part of the room is apt to be 10° or 15° lower than that of the upper.

It is indispensable in all forms of labor requiring the exercise of vision for minute objects that the worker should rise from his task now and then, take a few deep inspirations with closed mouth, stretch the frame out into the most erect posture, throw the arms backward and forward, and if possible, step to a window or into the open air, if only for a moment. Two desks or tables in a room are valuable for a student; one to stand at, the other to sit at.

A COSTLY PRESENT TO THE CZAR OF RUSSIA.—The Czar will soon receive a magnificent present from the Corporation of London, in the form of a casket weighing nearly 70 ounces, and composed of the finest gold and enamel. It is of the cinque-cento style, oblong in form, 12 inches in length, 9 inches in width, 12 inches in height, and supported at the four corners by enamelled Imperial Russian eagles, resting on malachite globes. The reverse side of the casket bears the inscription: "To H. I. M. Alexander II., Emperor of All the Russias, from the Corporation of the City of London, 18th of May, 1874." On the obverse side of the casket is the picture of the presentation of the address to the Czar from drawings taken at the ceremony, and executed in enamel on a plate of the finest gold, 4½ inches high in length and 2½ inches in height. In this small space eleven highly finished miniature portraits are executed, all the dresses and decorations worn on the occasion being accurately rendered. The Emperor is standing upon the dais in the Guildhall; on his right are the Duchess of Edinburgh, the Princess of Wales and the Grand Duke Alexis of Russia. On the left of the Emperor are the Princess of Wales, the Duke of Edinburgh, in Russian naval uniform, and the Duke of Cambridge, completing the royal group. The Corporation is represented by its chief magistrate, the late Lord Mayor, Sir Andrew Lusk, Bart., M. P., in his state robe of ermine and scarlet, and Mr. Russell Gurney, Q.C., M.P., the Recorder; the latter reading the address to the Emperor. Mr. Edward Hart, Chairman of the Reception Committee, who proposed the address in the Court of Common Council, stands near the Recorder, wearing his blue gown of office, and on his right Mr. Alderman Besley, in scarlet robes. The end panels contain views in enamel of the east and west windows of the Guildhall, with the figures of Gog and Magog. In the small side panels are the arms of Sheriffs Sir J. H. Johnson, Sir Charles Whetham, Alderman Besley and Mr. Edward Hart. The arms of the Corporation, supported by allegorical figures, artistically modeled and chased, surmount the casket.

AN ENAMELLED CEILING.—The London *Times* says: Among the decorative works in majolica, mosaics, *sgraffito*, stained glass, &c., which were originated in the South Kensington Museum some years ago, when the late Marquis of Salisbury and Lord Granville were Lords President, but which have lately been going on slowly or been actually suspended, is a ceiling made of thin plates of iron, and enamelled. This ceiling has just been put up in its place in the central refreshment room, and is probably the first experiment of the kind which has been attempted. The decorations of this room were designed to resist all dirt and impurities incident to a public room where food is eaten by an average of 10,000 persons a week. The walls and columns are of majolica, the floor is paved, and the ceilings are of iron enamelled. The whole gives an impression of perfect cleanliness, and every part might be washed down by a fire-engine weekly, if necessary. The iron ceiling was designed and painted by Mr. James Gamble, a successor and pupil of the late Godfrey Sykes, who practically founded the school at the Museum. The artistic work of the ceiling was done at the South Kensington Museum, until the action of the decorative studio was virtually suspended. The manufacturing part of this ceiling was done at Birmingham by the Enamelled Iron Company, the white enamelled plates being sent from Birmingham, and painted with charming and vigorous arabesques by the artist. The work is highly effective and the experiment successful. In cases where it is necessary to keep a ceiling clean and to wash it frequently, this material promises to answer perfectly, and the artistic work will last for centuries, as the design is burnt into the enamel.

Chatham, on retiring from office, sold his carriage-horses. Tory journals call attention to the fact that Sir John Macdonald has gone back to his law-office. Sir John Macdonald is not Chatham; his influence on the character of the Canadian people has been the very opposite of that which the high-souled dictator of the British Parliament exercised on the character of the English people. But he is like Chatham in this, that he has been personally pure notwithstanding great temptations and in the midst of corruption. The recording angel has no doubt taken note of the fact, and it will go to Sir John's credit in the historic judgment day. Unfortunately though incorrupt, in the personal sense, himself, he has been the grand corrupter of others, and he has done perhaps the very greatest injury which it is possible for a statesman to do to a young community by lowering the tone of public life. In truth we ought to compare him, not to Chatham, but to Newcastle, who, though his name is synonymous with corruption and he was the great master of that system, remained personally disinterested, and went out of power with his private fortune greatly impaired. Moreover, Chatham would never have tolerated near him some of the principal confederates of Sir John Macdonald. The system of Newcastle will not be restored in England, nor, as we believe, will that of Sir John Macdonald in Canada. The verdict of the people at the last general election was decisive.—*The Nation.*

A story is told by a newly-married couple who commenced housekeeping with a turkey dinner. The wife took great pride in having it all ready when John came home. John came, and shortly after the young husband, with a very pale expression of countenance, was seen to stride across the back-yard and throw a whole turkey over the fence. The inexperienced housewife had roasted it without removing the interior works, and it was altogether too much turkey for him.

To a picture of a frightfully wan, emaciated girl, exhibited in Paris, is ascribed this history: It is the portrait of an artist's sweetheart. He began to paint it when she was healthy and beautiful, but while the work was in progress she fell sick with consumption, and slowly wasted away. As the deadly disease changed her looks he touched and retouched her likeness, until just before her death it grew to be what it now is.

It is remarked that no man can become thoroughly acquainted with his family history until he runs for office.

NOTES ON FARMING, ETC.

Effect of Weather on Crops.

The farmer has not only to put in his crops and harvest them; he has to see that they are put in well, so that a good harvest may be realized, and this embraces a wide field, with many points to be considered. Upon the faithful performance of all these is dependent the great success of our best farmers.

The weather, in its great variety, is one of these points to be considered, or rather is a part that contains many points. There are some plants, for instance, that require more warmth and more moisture than others, and *vice versa*. Wheat, grass, potatoes and oats thrive best in a cool, moist climate, and the cabbage still more so. There are others of the same nature. On the other hand, corn loves the sun, with a moderate proportion of moisture. Warm, showery weather has always been found the best for this crop. The grape-vine is eminently a plant of this kind, only it requires less moisture. In this respect, it is in direct contrast with the cabbage and with the different berries. The gardener knows well that some plants require more water than others; some demand more heat. Then again, other circumstances have an influence. Trees and deep-rooted plants require less moisture from the atmosphere, being supplied from the depths of the soil. The hygrometric condition of the atmosphere, which affects the smaller and shallow-rooted vegetation so much, has, comparatively, but little influence on trees.

There is much more that might be mentioned that complicates the matter (and farther increases the embarrassment of the farmer), without embracing the different bonds of latitude which constitute the zones, but only confine myself to our own, and I may say, very changeable, temperate climate.

But can these changes and extremes in connection with our various vegetation be successfully met? Can we in effect harmonize these contradictory elements? It is done, happily, to a great extent, but it requires discrimination—a knowledge of all that applies to the case, and that is much. There must be close observation in extensive practice. A man must make his own science here, as no regular system covering the case is found in books. The first requirement is the proper condition of the soil, and that means a general, good soil—that is, well balanced, drained and in a mellow and tolerably fertile condition, varied otherwise as circumstances or crops may require. Where there is deep drainage, a deep, good sub-soil, with surface to match, as in our large river bottoms and land thoroughly prepared in similar condition, the basis for achievement is laid. The conditions for warmth and coolness, moisture and dryness, and for sound, healthy growth, are met. The severe effect of winter and spring frost is lessened, excess of moisture passes off, drouth is withstood, and other good results are secured.

With this basis of a good soil there is little difficulty to adjust the rest, as already much is accomplished. To come right to the point of the opposite requirements of the different crops, such as wheat, which demands a cool, moist condition, and corn, which requires warmth, we need but refer each to its own particular place in the season—wheat to the fall and spring or early summer growth, corn to occupy the hot summer months. So we also put out our spring crops of oats and barley early, because they are hardy and suited to the cool rather than the hot months. It is therefore recommended and practiced by the best farmers to put out these and other spring crops as early as the ground will admit, and a drained soil will admit it earlier than an undrained. We avoid sowing spring grain in June. Still later is still worse. Corn is put out late, so as to get the benefit of the heat at the start—which is required—and the full heat of the summer, to be ripened in the warmth of early autumn.

But there are other things to be considered. The summer may be a cool one: what then shall be done with corn? In such a case we select a black, low soil between hills which reflect and concentrate the rays of the sun, and keep off the cold winds. It must be a cold season indeed that will not grow a good crop in a deep, rich, well guarded river. So, to avoid failure, we confine our grain to the uplands, where it is comparatively cooler, yet seldom cold enough, on a deep, rich, well-drained soil, to produce even an approach to failure. We put our grapes where we think we can get the most heat, on land inclining to the south or east. But we do not get it there; we get it on an elevated, northern inclination, where the vine faces the sun all day, from his earliest rising to his latest setting, which is earlier and later than the valley sees him, and much earlier than with a southern inclination, where the hill, extending above the vine, is so much a bar to the sun's early and late appearance in the summer, when the sun rises north of east and sets north of west, thus favoring a northern exposure. I give this as my own experience, and for many years. Immunity from excessive wet is difficult to secure; we must take our risk with the climate, which, fortunately, is dry rather than moist during the hot summer months and this is favorable—a general drouth suits the grape. We can supply the lack of soil-moisture by attention to the land. Thorough and deep drainage—in other words, porosity—will do this. A cellar is an excellent drain. This, in addition to surface cultivation and mulching, will afford sufficient moisture even in a severe drouth to grow a good crop; and such a soil will readily draw off all surplus water. There will be no prolonged humidity from evaporation, as where water is kept in excess in the soil near the surface.

The effect of drouth on hoed crops, and the garden, can be much mitigated and almost overcome by a continued stirring of the soil till the crop shades it and prevents further working. Here both moisture and fertility are largely added—much more than is usually supposed, as only very few make the work sufficiently thorough and continuous. Capillary moisture from below and condensed moisture from the atmosphere at the surface are obtained by mixing air with the soil in stirring and in its porous condition. The ground and the atmosphere are the two great reservoirs of water, holding a superabundance at all times. These two sources must be drawn upon in a drouth, and by the means indicated, and not the surplus water in streams and lakes. (This last comes under the head of irrigation, and must be considered by itself.)

From all this, and much more that might be said, it will be seen there is nothing new in the means required for meeting the irregularities of the season; it is only the known principles of agriculture, known to the best tillers of the soil, and more or less carried out by them. And this is well; for not only the effect of the weather is thus measurably controlled, but the same means that require this, answer also the purpose of general farming; it is simply the thorough improvement of the soil with a view to adaptability to the production of the various crops, making the farm a machine for the purpose desired. It pays to do this, and it will soon be the only way that will pay. The sooner, therefore, that the farmer avails himself of all the advantages, the better.—*F. G. in the Country Gentleman.*

Selection of Thrifty Stock.

SUGGESTIONS ABOUT BREEDING.

In fattening animals much depends on having good, thrifty stock to begin with. There is a great difference in this respect, some animals eating heartily at all times, while others are always dainty and poor feeders, particularly among ordinary native or grade cattle. Doubtless there is equal difference in specimens of full-bred cattle, and it is worth more attention than it usually receives. A pedigree is a good thing, but only as it indicates good feeding, fattening or milking qualities. All signs fail sometimes, and the result of the most careful breeding will occasionally be a degenerate specimen, ill-favored and practically worthless for breeding purposes. Such animals should be sent to the shambles at once, no matter what the loss may be to fancy breeders. This is one objection to the pedigree system. The fact that an animal is registered in a herd-book gives it a value of hundreds, perhaps thousands, of dollars, without much regard to its intrinsic merits. Unless there be some rule of this kind, the cupidity of breeders will naturally prevent the careful selection which should prevail as much after a herd-book is opened as before. Good breeds are originated by carefully weeding out inferior specimens. If this process be not continued, the breed will degenerate. It is an interesting question for buyers whether defective animals from pedigree stock are ever refused admission to the herd-book. There is such a thing as reversion to the original type, and if this be not recognized, registries and pedigrees may be used to perpetuate and disseminate defects as well as excellencies. Breeders and purchasers do recognize this fact to some extent, as is shown by the different values fixed on animals from the same strain. In my judgment the intrinsic worth of the animal ought to have greater influence in fixing its price, and the pedigree less. This might not be so profitable a rule for breeders, but it would be better for the purchasers and the public.

As regards general thriftiness, much may be done by proper treatment and feeding while young. Even an old animal may, with care, be taught to eat almost anything fit for food. This is particularly important for cows. As a general rule, a good milker is never a poor feeder, and where the tendency to milk is established, the more a cow eats the greater the amount of milk produced. In many neighborhoods some poor laboring man has usually a better cow than wealthier farmers, and one reason is that the poor man's cow gets a greater variety of food, and is therefore always a hearty feeder, obeying, Paul's injunction, "whatsoever is set before you, eat, asking no questions, for conscience sake." A cow that will not do this had better be turned over to the butcher, or sold as quickly as possible. I would begin much younger, as it is easy to decide whether a calf gives promise of thriftiness or otherwise. The common way of selling those calves that thrive best, and therefore bring the highest price, is all wrong. Better sell the worst and keep the best, either for beef or milk. W. J. F. *Monroe County, N. Y.*

WEEDS.—A PRACTICAL HINT.—Cultivators are gradually learning that there is a hard and an easy way to do things. We have often spoken of the importance of killing weeds before they came up, or before they have reached a tenth of an inch in height. It is then done with the single stroke of a steel rake if in the garden, or by the single passage of a light harrow, on the field. It is often hard to beat this truth into the heads of laborers. We therefore tried it by marking the time required for each mode, by the watch. A bed of flowers, containing eighty square feet, is raked once a week, whether the weeds appear or not. It requires four minutes for each raking; and for the entire months of May, June and July, forty-eight minutes. This leaves the bed perfectly clean and mellow, and the plants have the best possible chance. If the ground is full of foul seeds, they will come up in warm, moist growing weather in one week, and once or twice their green points had just appeared when the weekly raking was given. In another bed of equal size, where this is omitted, they came up in a week, and in two more weeks are from three to six inches high—requiring over one hour to clear all out by hoe and hand. This must be repeated every three weeks, or four times in the three months, requiring half a day's work to keep the weeds under for three months, and even then doing it imperfectly.

CANADIAN AGRICULTURAL PROGRESS.

The Champion Reaper and Mower Manufactured at Oshawa.—Immense Success.—2,500 to be Manufactured this Year.

[From the Farmer's Advocate, June, 1875.]

In every branch of business where money is to be made, men of energy, spirit and ability strive hard to obtain it. Capitalists will advance money whenever they see a good prospect of making a good interest for money invested.

Immense sums are annually expended on the importation and feeding of stock. Some have made money by it, others have lost. We have the names of the successful ones constantly before us; the losers drop down and are heard of no more. A great deal has been made by manufacturers of all the wares we use, but in every business there has been those who gain and those who lose. Great profits increase competition, until some are sure to lose.

Agricultural implement manufactures have been perhaps as successful as any. Farmers have paid high prices for many of their implements, and do so now for some. Large manufacturers must be men of business and ability as they can command money as long as they can show to the bankers and capitalists that more than common interest can be made. The reaping and mowing machine business has been very profitable to manufacturers; immense establishments have been built up in various parts of America for their construction.

We persume Mr. W.N. Whiteley, of Springfield, Ohio, stands foremost at the present time as inventor, patentee and manufacturer of reaping and mowing machines. He invented the Champion reaper and mower. It is claimed that this machine will do its work better than any other in standing and lodged grain, that it is of lighter draft, more durable, less liable to get out of order, and is the most perfect harvester and mower in the world. Thirty-two thousand of these machines are being made in the States this year.

The Champion reapers are also constructed in Oshawa by the Joseph Hall Manufacturing Company. Mr. F. W. Glen, the present manager of this company, took us through this large establishment, which we consider the king of Canadian agricultural implement manufactories. Four hundred men are now employed in this establishment. The great work now in progress is the construction of the Champion mowers and reapers. We were shown the process from the making of the wrought iron frames to the finishing touches of the painters. The hands, as we passed through, were not only fitting, but in two places had the works put in running order to be sure of their being right. At the last place the whole machine was fitted and run by steam power at double speed to have it fairly tested in all its parts. Even the wood was imported from Ohio, as they could not procure it here of sufficient strength to suit them. The greatest care appears to be bestowed on their construction and on the material used.

This company is now constructing from 25 to 30 machines per day. At the time we were there—May 12th—600 had been shipped, and orders were in for 700 more. This company intends manufacturing 2,500 this year; they only manufactured 250 last year, but the reports of the great satisfaction they gave ensures their sale this season. They intend making 4,000 next year, and devoting their whole force and energies on these machines; they are already making their preparations.

We approve of specialties, and believe that better implements can be got up at cheaper rates when a person or firm devote their whole attention to a specialty.

They have disposed of their hay rake, seed drill and broadcast seeder patterns and interest to a new company formed in Oshawa, under the name of the Masson Manufacturing Company, with a capital of $100,000. The new company has now purchased the Hat Factory for its work.

Mr. Glen has fortunately secured the good will and aid of Mr. Whiteley, the inventor of the Champion and the owner of the most valuable reaper and mower patents in the States, Canada and Europe; Mr. Whiteley stands among manufacturers as Mr. Barnum does among showmen—minus Barnum's humbug. He has also secured the good will and aid of Mr. L. H. Lee, a most experienced manufacturer. Thus he feels doubly safe in his great undertaking.

We must congratulate the inhabitants of Oshawa on the acquisition gained in securing Mr. Whiteley's aid and capital; this will tend to make Oshawa the Sheffield of Canada, and greatly add to the prosperity of this already prosperous place. No town we know of shows greater signs of prosperity; at twelve and six o'clock the streets are almost black with mechanics, resembling bees at swarming time as they come from the various factories. Other large works are also to be established at this place.

INFORMAL PEOPLE.—Preserve us from uncermonious people—those men and women who "never stand on ceremony"—who are always perfectly at home in other people's houses! Society has many pests, but few so intolerable as they. "Free and easy" visitors are most thoroughly disagreeable. They will inflict themselves upon you at any time, and expect to be always cordially welcomed, because they are so free and easy and so loth to put any body to trouble. They will come before breakfast, or just as you are sitting at dinner, and draw up their chairs quite like one of the family. Early in the morning they delight to "run in," and they will come right up to your chamber to save you the trouble of coming down, and there they sit and watch you make your toilet, and comment on how grey your hair is getting, and wonder if you are not a great deal stouter and redder in the face than you used to be. They will hunt over your writing desk for note-paper, bathe their faces with your cologne water, and scent their handkerchiefs with the contents of your choicest perfumery bottle. They are always ready for luncheon—"You know I'm too much at home in your house to go hungry, my dear"—and any stray confectionery lying about melts before them as dew before the sun. They make no scruple of borrowing your latest magazines and novels; even your wardrobe does not escape their encroachments; and all this insolence is cloaked by some such empty remarks as these: "I never stand on ceremony, but make myself at home everywhere, so don't put yourself out to entertain me!" Again we pray, preserve us from uncermonious people!

In England, infants, says the *Pall Mall Gazette*, are unfortunately held to be of no value by a large portion of Her Majesty's subjects, and are pitched into gutters, or over garden walls, as though they were mere rubbish. In Scotland, a more sober and serious country, parents attach a far higher value to babies, and even the poorest of the poor will only consent to part from their offspring for "a consideration." A touching instance of this appreciation of their value is afforded by the story of a baby six weeks old, and on whose behalf application was made to the inspector of poor at Airdrie for relief, by a woman named McManus, who stated that it had been left in her arms by a woman at the College station, Glasgow, on the previous night. The application was refused, but further inquiry by the inspector completely exonerated the mother, whose name, it appears, is Agnes Boyle, from the charge of having thus deserted her child. It was stated by several persons who witnessed the transaction that Boyle had sold the child to Mrs. McManus for the sum of one penny. The lady, however, being dissatisfied with her bargain, the child is to be returned to "the friends of the mother."

Prof. Huxley tells a good story in his last essay. It is concerning the hod-carriers, one of whom bet the other that he couldn't carry him in his hod, to the top of his ladder. He lost the wager, and remarked, after being safely landed, that he "had great hopes of falling at the third round from the top."

Will the gentlemen who preside over the sprinkling carts please be a little less lavish in distributing their fluid on the crosswalks. Water is all very well, but on sidewalks it seriously interferes with a dainty balbriggan and mars the lustre of a recently polished boot.

The Sombra Murder.

In our last issue we gave some account of the murder of Mr. R. S. Finlay, at his residence in the Township of Sombra on the morning of Saturday. From the developments which were made during the course of the inquest, it would appear that there was no suspicion at first that he had been murdered by the inmates of his own house, but that the murder had been committed by some person or persons who had gone to the place for the purpose of stealing the horses, and had committed the murder when they found they were discovered, in order to avoid detection. It appears that both Mrs. Finlay and the man Smith manifested great reluctance to attend the funeral, and that this circumstance, unusual as it is in country places, on the part of either male or female friends, led the neighbors to suspect that they must have known more about Mr. Finlay's death than they wished to admit. In order to have the mystery solved, Dr. Mott of Dresden, formerly of Wyoming, and still a Coroner for the County of Lambton, was telegraphed for. On his arrival, he found the body in the position in which it fell after the fatal shot was fired. He at once summoned a jury, and proceeded to make the necessary inquiry into the cause of the poor man's death. A *post mortem* examination showed that deceased had been shot just below the left ear, the charge passing directly through his head, scattering his brains over the ceiling and wall of the stable. The gun with which the murder was committed lay near by, and the padlock and key of the stable were still in his hand, and the lantern a few feet from the body, broken as if thrown from his hand as he fell; but the nature and position of the shot precluded the idea that he had taken his own life.

Mrs. Finlay was the first witness examined by the Coroner. She stated that her husband was a native of Ireland, and was forty-three years of age; they were married in the Township of Dover nine years ago, and had lived in Sombra three years. He was in tolerable health, but subject to fits of despondency, and people would sometimes say to her he was crazy. On the day previous to his death he complained of weariness, and went to bed about 9 o'clock, she retiring about an hour later. About 1 o'clock in the morning Mr. Finlay got up and went to the stable, to see what was wrong with the horses, there being a noise in the stable. Not returning soon, and hearing more noise, she called the men, who went to the stable and found him dead. She stated in reply to the Coroner, that they had "mostly," lived agreeably; but had differed about living on the farm, she being opposed to farming.

Smith, the hired man, said he was born in Ireland, but had been in Canada since 1861. Had lived in Toronto three years; went from Toronto to London, where he tended bar for his brother, who kept the Thomson House; had worked in a flax mill in Belmont for about six months; went from there to Arkona and worked in a flax mill there; had known Mr. Finlay for three years; had left him last spring on account of a quarrel about wages, but had returned to him at the instance of his wife. He said Mr. Finlay abused his wife and children; but this was contradicted by several other witnesses who had lived with the family from time to time.

The impression seems to prevail in the neighborhood that Mrs. Finlay was unfaithful to her marriage vows, and that a criminal intimacy had existed between her and Smith for some time; and the admission she made in her confession, to the effect that Smith told her on the previous Friday that he had laid a plan to murder Mr. Finlay, naturally strengthens the suspicion that the plot had been concocted between them; otherwise she certainly would have warned her husband of it, and prevented him going to the stable on Saturday morning. Her confession we gave in our last issue; and upon that, and the other evidence taken, the jury rendered a verdict of "wilful murder" against William Henry Smith and Mrs. Finlay as an accomplice thereto; and they were committed to take their trial at the coming Assizes here. Smith arrived by the J. C. Clark on Friday forenoon, and Mrs. Finlay in the afternoon, by a carriage, having objected to come by the boat, and the Coroner having acceded to her request to be sent by land.

This "Finlay horror" has created intense excitement in the county, especially in the neighborhood where it took place, being in many particulars a counterpart to the Nissouri tragedy which occurred two or three years ago, and prompted by the same causes. The parties, moreover, are much alike, Mrs. Finlay being in physical appearance and temperament very like Mrs. Campbell, while Smith does not look like a man who would commit such a dastardly cold-blooded deed. Both, especially Mrs. Finlay, are said to have felt intense remorse at the result, and it was no doubt the accumulating horrors of her situation that caused her to give way and make the confession she did.—*Sarnia Observer.*

OLD TIME GIANTS.—An English correspondent says: In Pepy's Diary for June 9, 1668, where his visit to Oxford is recorded, he tells how he went to Brasenose College, and says, "in the cellar find the hand of the Child of Hales, long; butler, two shillings." A late editor adds, "does this mean, 'slipped two shillings into the child's hand?'" The suggestion is unlucky; surely Pepys did not mean a living child, but a Child entitled to a capital letter, after the manner of "Childe Harold" and "Childe Waters." At Hale in Lancashire there is a tradition of a "Child of Hale," a giant whose figure may be seen on a local signboard, and who is said to have lived about a generation before Pepys, and who is further said to have been at first small of stature, but to have been lengthened in answer to prayer, as Alice in Wonderland was without prayer. And in Hale church-yard is the tomb of "John Middleton, the Child," who died early in the seventeenth century, on which is further graven, without any grammatical relation to the rest of the epitaph, the words, "Nine Feet Three." This has been naturally taken to mean the height of the giant; but the tomb is certainly not longer than the seven feet of ground allotted to ordinary men. Sceptics have therefore suggested that the inscription must have meant something else, and that the story of the giant may have grown out of the inscription. Yet here is a "Child of Hale," who was clearly well-known a little later than the assigned date, and who had a "long" hand, as a giant of the height of nine feet three might reasonably be expected to have. Only how did the hand of a giant or any other person buried in a church-yard in Lancashire get into the cellar of Brasenose College? The subject is mysterious; perhaps some of the correspondents of *Notes and Queries* may know something about it. Anyhow, Mr. Pepys certainly never dropped two shillings into the living hand, long or short, of "John Middleton the Child," who died about the time of Mr. Pepys's birth.

THE HOLYOKE DISASTER.—VERDICT OF THE JURY.—The jury to inquire into the manner of the Holyoke disaster place the responsibility solely on those who constructed the galleries in the church, which having a holding capacity of 400 persons, had no means of exit except one narrow stairway. They find that all the deaths occurring from the disaster were of persons seated in the galleries. They condemn those responsible for the building of the church in the strongest terms; and further, find that the direct cause of the fire, with its terrible sacrifice of human life, is attributable to the use of laces, paper, etc., about the altar, and the fact that the building was sheathed with pine sheating, instead of being plastered. They strongly deprecate the use of such adornment, and the use of such finish in places of public resort; and, in conclusion, admonish corporations, or persons owning, or having in charge, public halls or churches, to guard against the possibility of such a disaster being repeated, assuring such that the public will hold them to strict accountability.

REFORM MEETING.—The members of the Reform Party in the County of Welland will meet at the Town Hall, Crowland, on Saturday next, 5th inst., at the hour of 11 o'clock a. m., for the purpose of electing officers for the current year, and the transaction of general business. Mr. Currie and other leading Reformers will be present. Should a nomination be made, which we consider not at all unlikely, especially if the meeting is largely attended, Mr. Currie will without question be the unanimous choice. He has to-day a firmer hold on the confidence of the people of this county than he has ever had before, and with proper exertions will undoubtedly poll a larger majority than the county has ever yet given him. A general meeting of the Reformers on Saturday next is strongly urged. —*Welland Tribune.*

Father Lake, assistant pastor of St. Ann's Church, whose sermon attacking the public schools created so much stir last winter and occasioned his suspension by the Archbishop, was recently married in this city to a young lady from Lorraine, and has taken up his residence in San Francisco. Father Lake is an American and a convert, and his secession and marriage occasions a marked sensation in Roman Catholic circles.—*New York telegram.*

HONORING THE DEAD.—The graves in old Concord, Mass., near the battle ground of the Revolution, where the English soldiers were buried, was decorated on Sunday with the British flag, wreaths and flowers. The following inscription was placed upon the staff: "In memory of our countrymen who fell in the discharge of their duty on the 19th of April, 1775, the Englishmen of Waltham have placed this tribute."

Said a saucy beauty to a foppish fellow who bored her with his compliments: "Your presence and conversation are vastly agreeable, and what is remarkable your attractiveness doesn't seem to depend upon brains at all."

Sergeant Bates is advised by some one, if he wants to do a really daring act, to try to carry the Pope's flag through Germany.

The story entitled the "Dilemma," just begun in *Blackwood's Magazine*, is said to be from the pen of the author of the "Battle of Dorking."

James Gordon Bennett will bring with him on his return from Europe this month, *on dit*, four $3,000 pointers and some choice horses from the best English pedigrees.

Humor.

What is the difference between the Emperor William's chronometer and a bill-poster? One is a Bill's ticker, and the other a bill-sticker.

A certain Western editor, who was presented with a box of collars in pay for an advertisement, is waiting in daily expectation that some one will present him with a shirt.

Take life easy, and don't always be trying to beat the sun up. You may win for a while, but in the long run you are sure to be beaten, and some morning it will rise when you don't.

He held the old shirt up by the neck before discarding it forever, but he wasn't mourning for the garment. He only said thusly: "I wish I had all the drinks again that have gone through that old neckband!"

A gentleman advertises his willingness to exchange a cork leg for a revolver. This is the nearest approach to the old law of retaliation we have seen for a long time. It isn't an eye for an eye—but it's a leg for an arm.

A literary ice cart driver, who has been annoyed by children who have been in the habit of pilfering his ice, now displays as a warning: "N. B." He thinks they will understand that that means "Take Not-ice!"

"Now, my son," said a Brooklyn father, "take this castor oil, or out you go through the window." "Boo-hoo-hoo!" said the little man, after applying the point of the spoon for a moment to his lips, "Me can't take it, papa. Fo me out de winner!"

Our confirmed materialist states that the difference between theology and science is, that one's a ledge and the other's no ledge. [If, as is surmised, the writer alludes to "allege" and "knowledge," then have spelling matches been in vain.—*Pr. Dev.*]

"Oh, yes, gimme 10 cents' wort of ha'rpins," added a farmer, as he was about to leave a store; and, while they were being handed down, he continued: "It's ha'rpins to-day, and ribbons to-morrow, and a tooth-brush the next day. The gal is always wanting some flim-flam thing, and I shouldn't be surprised if she'd some day get up and want me to bring home one of them combs with a brass back."

One of our physicians, who had been greatly annoyed by numerous questions concerning the condition of a certain patient, was stopped, while on his busy rounds, by a man, with the old question: "How's Mr. ——?" "Sick," replied the physician. "Does he keep his bed?" "Of course he does. You don't suppose he's fool enough to sell his bed because he's sick, do you?"

A miserably-shod tramp called upon a Danbury family for an old pair of shoes. The lady of the house gave him a shoe, observing: "I've only a pair to spare. I give you one, and will keep the other for some other unfortunate who may come along." The man dropped a grateful tear in behalf of the other unfortunate, it is supposed.—*Danbury News.*

FISHING.—An English writer says of fishing: We may imagine you arrived at your destination of an evening. You have sauntered out while supper is getting ready to make the most of the pleasures of hope. Your steps have strayed, of course, to the little bridge over the river, and you are leaning over the parapet in contemplation of the pool under the arch; the heavy trout hanging in mid-water, with their heads up stream, lazily steadying themselves by the flap of their tails. If you come out again after supper with your cigar you may have them rising about you in the darkness. Next morning you are naturally on the *qui qive*. Everything seems to conspire in your favor. There is a gray sky and a southerly wind, though you may have some enlivening gleams of sunshine later. The water is in prime condition, and as for the adventitious attractions of the stream, probably you know all about that beforehand. We have every respect for "fine fishing" in the Lowlands; for those slow streams in the chalk that Canon Kingsley has glorified, and even for sluggish water meandering through the mud, where your fly must fall light as the thistledown if you are to persuade anything to rise and swallow it. But for our own part, give us a good rattling, brattling river in the Highlands or among the brown, pastoral hills on the Borde. To say nothing of the freshness of the air, there is a wildness in the scenery which is a delightful change from the level of the pavements in the towns. You need not throw your whole soul into each separate cast, whipping up the fly the instant it has touched the surface and tempted nothing. Here the water comes down in a rapid rush, swirling round under the stones that give the biggest of the fish their resting places. There it eddies back under the bank it has hollowed away, and again, after taking it more quietly for a bit, it hurries on for another of its rushes, and finally tumbles down in miniature cataracts. At one place you come upon green meadow, where you may make your casts freely to your heart's content. At another you must fish out from under the hanging copsewood, sending your line out underhand with a dexterous turn of the arm. You may call it rough fishing if you will; it may be comparatively easy to hook unsophisticated fish in broken water, but when once they are hooked the fun begins in earnest. In the first place, and weight for weight, they are as vigorous and lively again as their lazier fellows of the Lowlands. In the next place they know by instinct how to make the most of their natural strongholds, and if you have not the happy art of humoring them, or if your tackle be not of the toughest they may have wound your line round some submerged boulder, or ground out the hook among the gravel, before you have had time to congratulate yourself on your capture. There is no speculating on the humors of fishes, which are proverbially more capricious than the most fanciful of the fair sex. But in a river of the kind we have imagined you may generally do something to your satisfaction unless it has run dry in the course of protracted drought, or unless it is coming down in turbid spate "from bank to brae," or if the atmosphere is not surcharged with electricity. Even if you are out of luck, you have enchanting nature to fall back upon, and every angler, if he means to make the best of his life, ought to handle the pencil as well as the rod, or else to do something in the way of the "ologies."

I have always been just comfortably poor all my life, and I have always had a pretty, cosy room to sit in; and I am quite sure that if a fairy godmother came down the chimney on purpose to bestow a large fortune on me, my next drawing-room would be stiff, and handsome, and comfortless, and I should never go into it unless absolutely obliged to do so. I have had drawing-rooms of canvas, where a hideous bare pole in the centre had to be concealed, and where the carpet was all too warm, and soft, and yielding to the feet—not from inherent richness of texture, for, indeed, it was only of blue and white cotton twill, but because of many feet of burning sand which lay beneath. Yet boughs of trees made that bare pole a green stem, from which hung spurs and whips, and even stirrups; bullock-trunks, with canvas stretchers between, made settees; and gaunt, folding-up tables could always be draped by gay Indian cloths. I am free to confess, however, that I date my first gray hairs from that tent drawing-room, which moved twenty-five miles ahead every day. Its furniture had a tendency to collapse, which was truly frightful; and the ingenuity of Indian servants in propping up a chair or table which really ought to have gone to the *misteri*, or carpenter, before it was put back in the tent, led, many a time and oft, to tragic and disastrous consequences. Then I have had to make officers' quarters pretty and homelike, in spite of the most hideous and ghastly wall-papers which could be procured for love or money; rooms with a net-work of bell-wires, running close to the ceiling, which gave an unmilitary visitor the impression that he or she had strayed into a head-centre telegraph office by mistake. In that room I always felt that everything was a sham. Nothing was what it professed and appeared to be; and I lived as one oppressed by a horrible secret, and in constant dread of some convulsion of nature exposing the frightful falseness of everything. Tables were not tables at all; they were only lids of boxes. Ottomans were be-cushioned and be-chintzed military chests; everything screwed on and off, or folded flat, in a distracting manner, even to the handles of the water-cans and the saucepans. Of course this folding up and unscrewing occasionally took place involuntarily, at wrong and unseasonable moments, and the result used to be confusion and "matter in the wrong place." But still there must have been some glamor of brightness and prettiness about it all, for the much-laughed-at little *salon* has left its own impression of home and happiness on one of the varied pages of my past life.—*Lady Barker's "Houses and Housekeeping" in "Evening Hours."*

SUPERIORITY OF DUCKS' EGGS OVER HENS' EGGS.—The following details are given as the results of French experiments: An ordinary hen's egg weighing 60.4 grammes was found to have 7.2 gr. of shell and skin, and 53.7 gr. of contents, the latter, therefore, forming 88.07 per cent. of the whole weight. A duck's egg, weighing 59.8 grammes, had 7.7 gr. of shell and skin, and 52.1 gr., or 87.12 per cent. of contents. Analysis of 100 grammes of the contents of hens' eggs gave 26.01 dry residue, 1.03 ash, 11.27 fatty matter in the form of sulphuret of carbon. An equal weight of the contents of ducks' eggs gave 28.89 dry residue, 1.16 ash, 15.48 fatty matter, showing that ducks' eggs contain a notably larger proportion of nutritive matter than hens' eggs. Comparison was also made of the productive powers of an equal number of ducks and hens. From January to August three hens laid together 257 eggs; three ducks in the same time laid 401 eggs. Besides this, the ducks laid 215 more eggs in autumn, whilst the hens were off the lay. Altogether the three ducks produced 617 eggs in the year, whilst the three hens laid 257 only.—*Practical Magazine.*

Items—Personal, Political and General.

The Carlist General, Saballo, with 2,00 men, were repulsed at Blanco, and sixty were killed.

The yearly meeting of the English Society of Friends has been held in London, beginning May 19.

The annual Convocation dinner of the University of Toronto comes off on Tuesday evening next.

Mr. Baker, the unseated member for Russell, will, it is stated, offer himself for re-election.

The Emperor William has conferred the Order of Civil Merit on Hon. George Bancroft and Henry W. Longfellow.

It is estimated that there were over a million dollars' worth of coral obtained last year from the Mediterranean by the coral-gatherers of Naples.

A western paper says that Mr. Monteith, the Conservative M. P. for North Perth, has decided to admit bribery by agents. The trial begins to-day.

The hearing of the evidence and arguments in the Peel election trial has been finished, and Chief Justice Draper will deliver judgment on Monday, 14th inst.

The English revisers of the New Testament held their fiftieth session May 10th. They furnished the revision to the 10th verse of the 10th chapter of Romans.

The corporation of London has resolved to invite the Mayor of New York to the International municipal banquet, next month in Guildhall.

The representatives of the Liverpool Transatlantic Steamship Company have come to an agreement in regard to rates of freight and passage fares.

The Port Dover *Independent* says the Conservatives of South Norfolk intend holding a pic-nic on the 30th inst., at which Sir John Macdonald, Dr. Tupper, and other prominent men of that party have promised to be present.

Twenty thousand pilgrims visited the shrine at Paray Le Monial yesterday. The Archbishop of Paris, the Archbishop of New Orleans and other distinguished prelates were present.

Great Britain is likely to have a war with Burmah. As the king has persistently violated his treaty and obligations, it would not be a sad affair if he should be severely punished.

The petitioners against the return of Mr. D. D. Hay, M.P.P. for North Perth, advertise that they desire to withdraw their petition on the ground that they have not sufficient evidence to sustain the charge made.

The Conservatives of Monck met on Saturday at Wellandport, and selected Mr. L. Macallum and Mr. George Secord as their candidates, in opposition to Mr. J. D. Edgar and Dr. Haney. Both Mr. Macallum and Dr. Haney are the late unseated members.

Thomas Sproat, a Grand Trunk employee, in going to assist at a fire on the track last evening, a few miles east of Lucan, fell into a culvert, struck on the top of his head, and was instantly killed. No inquest was required.

The French Derby for the Grand Prize of Paris was run on Saturday. The attendance was immense. The race was won easily by Salvator, with Nougatz 2nd, Perplexe 3rd, and Robagas 4th. Eleven ran, including the English horses Claremont, Camballo and Seymour, who were not placed.

The run of salmon in the Sacramento river is greater now than ever before known. There was a time when many thought that the steamboats and muddy water had kept them from their spawning grounds, but for two years past they have been becoming very numerous in the river, and now appear to be as plenty as they were in 1849-50.

During the fiscal year ending June 30th, 1876, over $4,850,000, according to the estimates of the Public Works Department, will be expended on the construction of the Pacific Railway. In the same time over four and a quarter million dollars will be required for improvements on the canals.

D. P. Cloyd, one of the editors of the Dardanelle *Independent* at Little Rock, Ark., shot and killed Hon. R. W. Wishart, a prominent lawyer and ex-member of the Legislature, at that place last evening. The affray was caused by some publication in the *Independent* reflecting on Wishart.

Many reports (says the *Globe*) have been put in circulation, by friends as well as foes, about proposed changes in the Cabinet of Ontario. Many of the statements are absurd, and others, if of a more probable character, are quite premature. When changes are made the public will, no doubt, be at once informed of their nature.

"The Reform party in all portions of this country are unanimous in their choice of candidates; they are well organized and conscious of their strength, and will no doubt do their best to carry the ensuing elections by an overwhelming majority." These are the sentiments of the Monck *Reform Press.*

The Peel election trial resumed at 9 o'clock yesterday morning, at Brampton, Mr. R. J. Cox acting as Registrar. The day was consumed in hearing rebutting evidence for the respondent. Much of it was in direct conflict with that of the petitioner, and considerable excitement was manifested during the day. The evidence in the case closed at 5 o'clock, and the Court adjourned till 8.30 this morning to hear the argument of counsel.

It is reported in Montreal that the Grand Trunk authorities are about to inaugurate a policy of retrenchment. Fewer trains will be run, supernumerary employees and extra hands will be discharged, while a few of the minor way stations, which are serious items of expense, with but small corresponding pecuniary returns, are to be closed up, at least for the present.

A fatal accident occurred on Saturday at a barn raising at Mr. Thomas Cowan's, in the township of Hullett, about five miles from Blythe. John L. Henderson was upon the building adjusting the plate, when he slipped and fell headforemost a distance of eighteen feet, and was killed instantly. Mr. Henderson was unmarried, fifty-five years of age, and was formerly a resident of the township of Esquesing.

A dog playing with some children on the beach at Port Colborne on Saturday evening behind the east pier brought to the shore the body of a man. It is much decomposed, and not recognizable. It is apparently that of a young man; has on coarse tweed pants, a cotton shirt, and dark brown smock or over-shirt, one new fine boot; small foot. The body was buried on Sunday.

The General Assemblies of the Established and Free Churches of Scotland opened May 20 at Edinburgh. The Rev. James Sellar, D. D., of Aberleur, was chosen Moderator of the Established Church Assembly, and the Earl of Rosslyn appeared as the Queen's representative. In the Free Church Assembly the Rev. Alexander Moody Stuart, D. D., of Edinburgh, was chosen Moderator in place of the retiring Moderator, Dr. Stuart of Leghorn.

The potato bugs are more numerous this season in Watford than on any former one. Potatoes coming through the ground are literally covered. The grub is doing a great deal of damage to oats and corn in this neighborhood. Numbers of acres which a week ago looked as if they would yield a bountiful harvest are completely cut down by the grub. Several parties have lost eight to ten acres of crop.

Mr. Joseph Rowntree, Junr., son of Mr. Joseph Rowntree, proprietor of the flour mills at St. Andrews, about four miles from Weston, was drowned in his own mill dam yesterday forenoon. Six or seven men were repairing the dam, the deceased amongst the number, and while working with a crow-bar, endeavouring to lift some part of the machinery, it slipped. The end struck him on the side, rendering him insensible, when he fell into the dam and sank in about ten feet of water. Six of the men working on the dam jumped in as soon as they saw Mr. Rowntree going to the bottom. Every effort was made to save him, but to no purpose.

A remarkable verdict was returned at the Cheshire Quarter Sessions, at Knutsford, in England, the other day. Two men, who were accused of destroying fish by putting chloride of lime into a stream at Woodford, were, after a long deliberation by the jury, found not guilty of the offence with which they were charged, but were, with solemn formality, pronounced guilty of "fishing," with which they were not charged. The Chairman, Sir Henry Mainwaring, characterized the verdict as the silliest he had ever heard in his life. The men were of course discharged.

A reform Convention for the county of Welland was held at Crowland on Saturday afternoon. The Town Hall was crowded. R. Coulter, Port Robinson, was Chairman, and J. J. Sidey, of the Welland *Tribune*, Secretary. Hon. J. G. Currie received the unanimous nomination to be the Reform candidate in the approaching election for the Ontario Legislature, which he, being present, accepted. The meeting was very enthusiastic, and there was a feeling of certainty of electing Mr. Currie, by a large majority. Mr. W. A. Thompson, M.P., was present, and addressed the meeting, cordially endorsing the proceedings.

The Holyoke disaster doubtless brings up in the recollection of those who have lately been in Santiago de Chili a corner plot of sodded ground, with a monument in its centre, marking the spot of the dreadful disaster in 1862. A Roman Catholic cathedral was full of women—two thousand of all classes, it is estimated, being present. The interior was decorated lavishly with colored paper and light cloth, and illuminated with lanterns. Twenty thousand candles and camphene lamps were burning. A breeze swung a flame against the altar drapery, and the congregation was almost instantaneously enveloped with fire. As at Holyoke, the single doorway was soon blocked, and egress rendered impossible. Only a few of the women escaped. Nearly every household lost a member, and the city has not yet recovered from the event.

The Manliest Man.

The manliest man of all the race
Whose heart is open as his face,
  Puts forth his hand to help another,
'Tis not the blood of kith and kin,
'Tis not the color of the skin;
'Tis the heart that beats within,
  Which makes the man a man and brother.

His words are warm upon his lips,
His heart beats to his finger tips,
  He is a friend and loyal neighbor;
Sweet children kiss him on the way,
And women trust him, for they may,
He owes no debts he cannot pay;
  He earns his bread with honest labor.

He lifts the fallen from the ground,
And puts his feet upon the round
  Of dreaming Jacob's starry ladder,
Which lifts him higher, day by day,
Towards the bright and heavenly way,
And farther from the tempter's sway,
  Which stingeth like the angry adder.

He strikes oppression to the dust,
He shares the blows aimed at the just,
  He shrinks not from the post of danger,
And, in the thickest of the fight,
He battles bravely for the right,
For that is mightier than might,
  Though cradled in a humble manger.

Hail to the manliest man! he comes
Not with the sound of horns and drums,
  Though grand as any duke, and grander;
He dawns upon the world, and light
Dispels the weary gloom of night,
And ills, like bats and owls, take flight—
  He's greater than great Alexander.

The Man with the Tin Trunk.

CANVASSING UNDER DISADVANTAGES—THE PROPRIETOR OF AN EXTERMINATOR IN DANGER OF EXTERMINATION—A MATCH FOR AN AGENT.

[From the Detroit Free Press.]

He smiled blandly as he halted for a moment in front of the City Hall. He looked like a man who could palm off almost anything on the public at 100 per cent. profit, and yet leave each customer in a grateful mood. He had a tin trunk in his hand, and as he sailed down Lafayette avenue the boys wondered whether the trunk contained tax receipts or horse liniment. The stranger halted in front of a residence, his smile deepened, and he mounted the steps and pulled the bell.

"Is the lady at home?" he inquired of the girl who answered the bell.

The girl thought he was the census taker, and she seated him in the parlor and called the lady of the house. When the lady entered the stranger rose, bowed, and said:

"Madam, I have just arrived in this town after a tour extending clear down to Florida, and wherever I went I was received with glad welcome."

"Did you wish to see my husband?" she asked as he opened the tin trunk.

"No, madame; I deal directly with the lady of the house in all cases. A woman will appreciate the virtues of my exterminator and purchase a bottle where a man will order me off the steps without glancing at it."

"Your—your what?" she asked.

"Madam," he replied, as he placed a four-ounce phial of dark liquid on the palm of his left hand, "madam, I desire to call your attention to my Sunset Bedbug Exterminator. It has been tried at home and abroad, and in no case has it failed to——"

"What do you mean, sir?" she demanded, getting very red in the face. "Leave this house instantly."

"Madam, I do not wish you to infer from my——"

"I want you to leave the house!" she shrieked.

"Madam, allow me to explain my——"

"I will call the police!" she screamed, making for the door, and he hastily locked his trunk and hurried out.

Going down the street about two blocks he saw the lady of the house at the parlor window, and instead of climbing the steps he stood under the window and politely said:

"Madam, I don't wish to even hint that any of the bedsteads in your house are inhabited by bedbugs, but——"

"What! What's that?" she exclaimed.

"I said that I hadn't the remotest idea that any of the bedsteads in your house were infested by bedbugs," he replied.

"Take yourself out of this yard!" she shouted, snatching a tidy off the back of a chair and brandishing it at him.

"Beg pardon, madam, but I should like to call your——"

"Get out!" she screamed; "get out, or I'll call the gardener!"

"I will go out, madam, but I wish you understood——"

"J-a-w-n! J-a-w-n!" she shouted out of a side window, but the exterminator agent was out of the yard before John got around the house.

He seemed discouraged as he walked down the street, but he had travelled less than a block when he saw a stout woman sitting on the front steps of a fine residence, fanning herself.

"Stout women are always good natured," he soloquized as he opened the gate.

"Haven't got anything for the grasshopper suffers!" she called out as he entered.

There was an angelic smile on his face as he approached the steps, set his trunk down, and said—

"My mission, madam, is even nobler than acting as agent for a distressed community. The grasshopper sufferers do not comprise a one-hundreth part of the world's population, while my misson is to relieve the whole world."

"I don't want any peppermint essence," she continued, as he started to unlock the trunk.

"Great heavens, madam, do I resemble a peddler of cheap essences?" he exclaimed. "I am not one. I am here in Detroit to enhance the comforts of the night—to produce pleasant dreams. Let me call your attention to my Sunset Bedbug Exterminator, a liquid warranted to——"

"Bed what?" she screamed, ceasing to fan her fat cheeks.

"My Sunset Bedbug Exterminator. It is to-day in use in the humble negro cabins on the banks of the Arkansaw, as well as in the royal palace of her Majesty Q——!"

"You r-r-rascal! you villyun!" she wheezed; "how dare yo insult me m——!"

"No insult, madam, it is a pure matter of——"

"Leave! Git o-w-t!" she screamed, clutching at his hair, and he had to go out in such hurry that he couldn't lock the trunk until he reached the walk.

He travelled several blocks and turned several corners before he halted again, and his smile faded away to a melancholy grin. He saw two or three ragged children at a gate, noticed that the house was old, and he braced up and entered.

"I vhants no zoap," said the woman of the house as she stood in the door.

"Soap, madam, soap? I have no soap. I noticed that you lived in an old house, and as old houses are pretty apt to be infested——"

"I vhants no bins or needles to-day!" she shouted.

"Madam, I am not a peddler of Yankee notions," he replied. "I am selling a liquid prepared only by myself, which is warranted to——"

"I vhants no baper gollars!" she exclaimed, motioning for him to leave.

"Paper collars!" I have often been mistaken for Shakspeare, madam, but never before for a paper collar peddler. Let me unlock my trunk and show——"

"I vhants no matches—no dobacco—no zigars!" she interrupted; and her husband came around the corner and, after eyeing the agent for a moment, remarked:

"If you don't be quick out of here I shall not have any shoking about it!"

At dusk last night the agent was sitting on a salt barrel in front of a commission house, and the shadows of evening were slowly deepening the melancholy look on his face.

A story is current in Paris, as follows: Vicompte de H—was seventy years old, but retained the freshness of youth mentally as well as physically. This was the result of an odd theory put into long practice. He lived always moderately, systematically reserving a proportionate share of entertainment for his old age. Certain books, plays and places were avoided by him until the time prescribed for them arrived, when he would enjoy them all the more because of the long anticipation. His appetite was regulated in the same cool manner. His object, he said, was to escape tiring of life, and to use the world's pleasure in the wisest and most rational way. In the realization of his plan he only reached opera a short time ago. "The Huguenots" was the one selected, and he was in a state of high excitement on the night of his first visit to the Grand Opera House. He had a whole box, and, being an ardent lover of Meyerbeer's music, he was enthusiastic in his admiration of the entertainment. At the end of the first act he fell from his chair and instantly died. The undue agitation had induced an attack of heart disease. In his desk was found a carefully prepared programme of pleasure that would have lasted him until his eightieth year. It included a tour of America, the reading of Dickens' works, etc.

Among turfmen in England there is a difference of opinion as to the relative merits of a first-class English race-horse and a horse of pure Arab blood. Admiral Rous, a great authority, one of the Jockey Club stewards, believes in the superiority of the English thoroughbred, and thinks that the improved race-horse can give an allowance in weight of 28 pounds to the Arabian. The result of a match which took place at the recent spring meeting at Newmarket in England between Avowal, a four-year-old colt—one-third of Arab and two-thirds of English blood—and the race-horse, Mr. Fox, seven years old, hardly sustains the Admiral's view. Avowal, although allowed only ten pounds, and having been in training but three weeks, won easily. It is argued that this result shows that the infusion of Arab blood palpably enhances the staying powers of the British thoroughbred, but, on the other hand, it is said that this match cannot be regarded as a true test, as Mr. Fox is far from being one of the best horses in England, having been beaten badly by Lowlander in the Hunt Cup, and Scamp in the Goodwood Stakes.